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Famous For Being *Famous*

BELIEVE IT OR NOT, SOCIAL MEDIA STAR **UORFI JAVED** THINKS SHE'S NOT WELL KNOWN ENOUGH. *FOLLOW KAR LO YAAR*, AMAZON PRIME VIDEO'S REALITY SERIES CENTRED AROUND HER LIFE, COULD REDRESS THAT

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

Uorfi Javed knew her life was tailormade for a reality show. A social media sensation, Uorfi is known for her risqué, quirky outfits which raise eyebrows and stoke controversy. Amazon Prime Video's series *Follow Kar Lo Yaar* (releasing on Aug. 23) follows Uorfi as she seeks fame, and reveals her vulnerabilities as a young woman trying to stay relevant in the fiercely competitive world of internet stars. "I haven't hidden anything, even my sex life... you'll know how much money I have in my account by the end of it," she says.

The show is full of 'Uorfisms'. "I will do anything to look young," she says while getting botox. "*Jab tak Uorfi ke paas nahi hoga private jet, tab tak Uorfi nahi hogi kissise wed* [I won't marry until I own a private jet]," she tells her gal gang over lunch. She makes the show's intent clear early on when she declares, "*Main banoogi India ki next Kim Kardashian*". These aren't scripted lines, she says.

The (melo)drama in the show comes courtesy Uorfi squabbling with her sisters—older Urusa and younger Asfi—who are trying to crack it as influencers in Mumbai. Was it hard to get her family to appear on the show? "The sisters are jobless, this is a huge opportunity for them," she says. "If there's a family head whose decision is final, it's me." That's because she's been supporting them back home in Lucknow—two younger siblings and a mother—since she turned 18 and moved to Mumbai. The arguments between the girls feel contrived, with voices raised and tears shed, but Uorfi claims they have "controlled themselves on camera".

THOUGH CONTRIVED AT TIMES, UORFI IS HONEST ENOUGH TO COME ACROSS IN THE SHOW AS INSECURE, VULNERABLE EVEN

Regardless, the Uorfi speaking to us is honest enough to come across as insecure, vulnerable even. "I still feel that I am not famous enough," she says. "I wake up feeling like I don't have much going on in life. *Aisa kya karoon jo famous ho jaoon*." It's why she gave Amazon Prime all access for two months and final say on the cut. "If I was handling the editing, there'd be chaos," she adds.

Whether Prime greenlights a second season of *Follow Kar Lo Yaar* depends on the response, but it helps Uorfi in her mission. Says Uorfi, "If there's only one life, I want to go out doing something. I want at least two generations to remember me after I die." ■

–Suhani Singh